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CHICAGO PUBLIC SCHOOLS

Interim CEO may stay at helm

School board to vote on making King permanent leader, concluding monthslong national search

By **Kate Armanini**
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

The Chicago Board of Education will vote Monday on whether to hire interim CEO Macquiline King permanently, concluding a monthslong national search for the school district’s next leader. If approved, her contract will be effective July 1 through June 30,

2029, according to an agenda posted on the board’s website Thursday. Her starting salary will be \$380,000. King, a Chicago native, has risen through the ranks of Chicago Public Schools, beginning her career as a teacher and later as a principal. She has helmed the district since June, following the December 2024 firing without cause of former CEO Pedro Martinez.

King was named as a finalist for the permanent position earlier this month. The other candidate was Sito Narcisse, the former superintendent of East Baton Rouge Parish Public Schools. Former New York City schools chief Meisha Porter was also a finalist but dropped out. The search for a new CEO was at times rocky. King applied but was initially not selected as a finalist. In November, the field was narrowed to two other candidates, but after one withdrew, the board began conducting new interviews.

Amid growing calls for her to remain in her role, King was added back as a finalist. The West Side NAACP, along with several elected board members, argued she should continue leading the district at least until a fully elected school board takes office next year. Those tensions came to a head in February, when a faction of six elected board members accused Mayor Brandon Johnson of sabotaging the search, as the district

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Chicago Public Schools interim CEO Macquiline King attends a CPS Board of Education meeting on March 4. **JOHN J. KIM/TRIBUNE**



Fans find seats in the bleachers on Thursday before the Cubs and Nationals play on opening day at Wrigley Field. **BRIAN CASSELLA/TRIBUNE**

‘OPENING DAY IS A HOLIDAY’

After a long, cold winter, baseball is back, along with hope and renewal

By **Andrew Carter** | CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Upon first light in Wrigleyville early Thursday, the marquee at Murphy’s Bleachers, the venerable bar at the corner of Waveland and Sheffield avenues, still counted down toward a day people had been anticipating for the past 166 days, since the Cubs ended last season. All around, the neighborhood was just starting to come to life, sidewalks filling with anticipation. Longtime season ticket holders were already lined up outside the entrance for the bleachers. A crowd of kids started to gather down the street for the Cubs’ “Blue Carpet,” and the arrival of players to the park. Vendors wheeled T-shirt stands into place and rolled beer carts into Wrigley, while a city slowly awoke to



**Nationals 10
Cubs 4**



**Brewers 14,
White Sox 2**

Rough starts for each Chicago team. **Sports**

the rebirth and hope that only a new baseball season can deliver. Five hours before first pitch, a new dawn had rendered the Murphy’s sign out of date. “Opening day or bust,” it read, in all caps, and the countdown had dwindled to one. But now that day had arrived, and a doorman climbed a ladder with a handful of letters and arranged them into a new message: “There’s no place like home,” followed by “Cubs @1:20.” The place opened not long after, at 8 a.m. sharp, and about a dozen people streamed inside and sidled up to the bar and partook in some of the first pours of the 2026 baseball season.

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President will sign emergency TSA order

Directive calls for DHS to pay airport agents immediately

By **Lisa Mascaro and Kevin Freking**
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — President Donald Trump said Thursday he would sign an emergency order instructing the Department of Homeland Security secretary to immediately pay Transportation Security Administration agents as Congress struggles to reach a deal to end the budget impasse that has jammed airports and left workers without paychecks. Trump announced his decision in a social media post saying he wanted to quickly stop the “Chaos at the Airports.” “It is not an easy thing to do, but I am going to do it!” the president posted. With pressure mounting, the White House had floated the extraordinary move of invoking a national emergency to pay TSA workers while senators reviewed a “last and final” offer to end the funding impasse that has jammed airports and disrupted travel. Democrats have been refusing to fund DHS as they demand changes to rein in Trump’s immi-

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CRETE TOWNSHIP

Neighbors mourn family killed in triple homicide

By **Evy Lewis**
DAILY SOUTHTOWN

Dozens of neighbors gathered on a quiet road Wednesday night in Crete Township to grieve three people killed in a triple homicide Monday, who were members of the same family. Jacob Lambert, 32, his mother, Stacy Forde, 54, and her husband, Patrick Forde, 55, were found dead in their home on East Norway Trail in Willow Brook Estates early Monday morning. Jenna Strouble, a St. John, Indiana, resident and the mother of Lambert’s children, was charged with the first-degree murder Tuesday. Terry Cox, pastor of First Apostolic Church of Steger, organized the vigil with his wife, Alyssa. He opened with a quote from Psalm 34:18. “The Lord is close to the broken-hearted, and saves those who are crushed in spirit,” he said. “We have all felt that crushing over these last many days.” Terry and Alyssa Cox were

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Grieving loss of fallen firefighter

Supporters mourn fallen Chicago firefighter Michael Altman during his visitation on Thursday at St. Rita of Cascia Shrine Chapel in the Ashburn neighborhood. Funeral services for the firefighter/EMT, who died from injuries fighting a blaze in Rogers Park last week, have been postponed after his wife went into labor Thursday morning. The funeral, originally planned for Friday, will take place at a later date, the Chicago Fire Department said in a statement. **COLIN BOYLE/BLOCK CLUB CHICAGO**



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